

NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter Sector Overview

Missouri — NLRB R14 (St. Louis) + NLRB R17 (Kansas City) Jurisdiction — May 2026

NAPCS Unionization Research • May 2026 • Template v8.0

Section 1: State Overview

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| State                      | Missouri                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Labor Board                | NLRB R14 (St. Louis) + NLRB R17 (Kansas City) — National Labor Relations Board — Region 14 (St. Louis) and Region 17 (Kansas City). Missouri State Board of Mediation (SLBA) has limited jurisdiction and does not cover independently incorporated charters.                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Governing Law              | RSMo Chapter 160.400-160.425 (Missouri charter school law). RSMo 160.400.1: "A charter school is an independent public school." RSMo 160.420: employment provisions (individual employee retention option only — no blanket district-CBA carryover). Mo. Const. Art. I 29: public-employee collective bargaining right (Independence-NEA v. Independence Sch. Dist., 2007). RSMo 105.510 excludes all teachers from the statutory public-sector labor act.       |
| Federal NLRB Jurisdiction  | YES — MO charters operated by nonprofit corporations are private employers under the NLRA. NLRB R14 (St. Louis) and R17 (Kansas City) are the operative boards. KIPP St. Louis High decertification (14-RD-341432) confirms NLRB jurisdiction. SLBA exception possible only for KCPS/SLPS-sponsored schools if employer-of-record is the district (verify).                                                                                                      |
| Right-to-Work              | NOT a Right-to-Work State — Missouri right-to-work law (RSMo §290.590, enacted 2017) was rejected by voter referendum August 7, 2018 (67% opposed). Missouri has no operative right-to-work statute. Union security provisions are available in collective bargaining agreements. (Missouri voters rejected right-to-work 67-33% in August 2018. The 2017 statute never took effect. Union security clauses are available in MO charter school CBAs under NLRA.) |
| For-Profit Operator Status | For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Card-Check Available       | NO — NLRB secret-ballot election required (private employer). NOT right-to-work: 2017 RTW law (SB 19) repealed by voters via Proposition A, Aug 7 2018 (~67% against). Missouri is a non-RTW state — union security agreements are permissible.                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Registry Sweep             | COMPLETE — May 2026 (Registry v69) — 81 charter schools searched                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Research Window            | May 29, 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

Section 2: Charter Sector Landscape

Total charter schools in Missouri: 81 (Charter School Registry v69 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 83 charter schools in Missouri as of May 2026). Registry v94 audit June 5, 2026: 81 Open. 1 Closed (Kansas City Girls Prep) + 1 Future (BELIEVE Academy STL) excluded per census methodology.). Unionization census figures reflect confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

| Category                                                            | Schools | % of Total | Notes                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Total Unionized Charter Schools in Missouri (active certifications) | 0       | 0%         | Zero active NLRB certifications. The one MO charter that organized (KIPP St. Louis High) was decertified May 2024. |
| Confirmed — Independent Certification (active)                      | 0       | 0%         | No active NLRB certification for any MO charter school as of May 2026.                                             |
| Decertified — Formerly Organized                                    | 1       | N/A        | KIPP St. Louis High (14-RD-341432) — AFT Local 420 certified Nov 2022; decertified May 29, 2024 (19-17, NRTW-      |

|                                                        |    |                     |                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------|----|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                        |    |                     | assisted). First St. Louis charter union; no first contract ever ratified.                                                                                   |
| Unverified — No Records Found (Full Protocol Complete) | 69 | 85% of open schools | 69 open schools: NLRB R14/R17 ADS + full 8-step non-portal protocol + W1-W4 WATCH steps complete. No signals found.                                          |
| Closed — Within/Pending Lookback Confirmation          | 1  | N/A                 | Kansas City Girls Prep High (KCPS-sponsored) — Registry v69 shows Closed; closure date not populated (lookback status pending confirmation). No union found. |
| Total Charter Schools (MO universe — Registry v69)     | 83 | 100%                | 81 Open + 1 Closed + 1 Future (BELIEVE Academy STL, not yet open). Two metros: Kansas City (R17) and St. Louis (R14).                                        |

### Charter Sector Enrollment

|                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Total Charter Enrollment                       | 25,751 students — 2.9% of state K–12 enrollment (889,059 total K–12 students)                                                                                                          |
| Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools | 20,690 students in network-affiliated schools — 80.3% of total charter enrollment                                                                                                      |
| Students in Organized Charter Schools          | 0 students documented                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Data Sources                                   | Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year. |

## Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

| CMO / EMO Name            | Type     | State Campuses | National Campuses † | Organized in State | Total Enrollment |
|---------------------------|----------|----------------|---------------------|--------------------|------------------|
| KIPP Missouri             | Network‡ | 8              | —                   | —                  | 3,116            |
| Confluence Academies      | Network‡ | 6              | —                   | —                  | 2,460            |
| Allen Village             | Network‡ | 5              | —                   | —                  | 384              |
| Frontier Schools          | Network‡ | 5              | —                   | —                  | 1,587            |
| Academie Lafayette        | Network‡ | 4              | —                   | —                  | 1,425            |
| Gateway Science Academy   | Network‡ | 4              | —                   | —                  | 1,666            |
| Momentum Academy          | Network‡ | 4              | —                   | —                  | 599              |
| Hogan Preparatory Academy | Network‡ | 3              | —                   | —                  | 843              |
| University Academy        | Network‡ | 3              | —                   | —                  | 1,111            |
| Guadalupe Centers Schools | Network‡ | 3              | —                   | —                  | 1,614            |

|                                                    |          |           |   |                                                           |       |
|----------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------|---|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Lift for Life Academy                              | Network‡ | 3         | — | —                                                         | 865   |
| Crossroads Charter Schools                         | Network‡ | 3         | — | —                                                         | 1,003 |
| Brookside Charter School                           | Network‡ | 2         | — | —                                                         | 800   |
| City Garden Montessori                             | Network‡ | 2         | — | —                                                         | 589   |
| North Side Community School                        | Network‡ | 2         | — | —                                                         | 433   |
| DeLaSalle Charter School                           | Network‡ | 2         | — | —                                                         | 220   |
| Ewing Marion Kauffman School                       | Network‡ | 2         | — | —                                                         | 961   |
| Citizens of the World Charter School - Kansas City | Network‡ | 2         | — | —                                                         | 388   |
| Kairos Academies                                   | Network‡ | 2         | — | —                                                         | 515   |
| Kansas City Girls Preparatory Academy              | Network‡ | 1         | — | —                                                         | 111   |
| <b>TOTAL — All CMO/EMO Schools in Missouri</b>     |          | <b>66</b> |   | <b>0 organized schools in network-affiliated charters</b> |       |

† National Campuses reflects total campuses operated by this network across all states, as reported in Charter School Registry v133. Provides context for networks operating in multiple states.

‡ Network (type unclassified) = operator present in Charter School Registry v133 but not yet classified in CMO Reference data. Contact registry project to add classification for these records.

20 network (type unclassified). Approximately 15 schools operate independently with no CMO/EMO affiliation. Source: Charter School Registry v133.

## Section 4: Legal Framework & Sector Overview

Findings are based on research as of May 2026.

### 1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework

RSMo Chapter 160.400-160.425 (Missouri charter school law). RSMo 160.400.1: "A charter school is an independent public school." RSMo 160.420: employment provisions (individual employee retention option only — no blanket district-CBA carryover). Mo. Const. Art. I 29: public-employee collective bargaining right (Independence-NEA v. Independence Sch. Dist., 2007). RSMo 105.510 excludes all teachers from the statutory public-sector labor act. Missouri is not a right-to-work state (Missouri right-to-work law (RSMo §290.590, enacted 2017) was rejected by voter referendum August 7, 2018 (67% opposed). Missouri has no operative right-to-work statute. Union security provisions are available in collective bargaining agreements.). Charter schools in Missouri are subject to NLRB jurisdiction as private employers (NLRB R14 (St. Louis) + NLRB R17 (Kansas City)). Secret ballot NLRB election is the required organizing pathway. Card-check is not available.

### 2: Charter Sector Structure

Missouri operates 81 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 25,751 students. 20 charter management organizations and education management organizations operate in Missouri. The largest networks by campus count are KIPP Missouri (8 campuses in state), Confluence Academies (6 campuses in state), Allen Village (5 campuses in state). Approximately 15 schools operate independently with no CMO or EMO affiliation. Network-level detail, including campus counts and total enrollment, appears in Section 3 above.

## Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

### Press Coverage

Missouri charter labor coverage centers entirely on KIPP St. Louis High. The St. Louis Post-Dispatch and The Labor Tribune covered the November 2022 certification, the April 2024 one-day strikes, and the May 2024 decertification (19-17). Coverage

documented ~50% annual staff turnover at the 440-student school and the dispute over third-party grievance arbitration and just-cause termination. Grand Center Arts Academy's 2015 organizing received limited contemporaneous coverage. No Kansas City charter organizing coverage found.

Stakeholder Communications

AFT St. Louis Local 420 publicly framed the KIPP decertification as an NRTW-driven loss while crediting its campaign with the 10% raises KIPP ultimately offered. Local 420 also represents St. Louis Public Schools teachers. No AFT communications referencing Kansas City charter organizing found. KIPP St. Louis leadership (executive director Garrett Kelly) maintained through the dispute that raises could not be awarded during bargaining under federal law; the documented posture included refusal of third-party grievance arbitration and just-cause termination protections.

Legislative Context

Missouri Proposition A (Aug 7, 2018): voters repealed the 2017 right-to-work law (SB 19) ~67% to 33% — the first state to reverse an enacted RTW law by referendum. Mo. Const. Art. I 29 (Independence-NEA v. Independence Sch. Dist., 2007): public employees, including teachers, have a constitutional collective-bargaining right, though RSMo 105.510 excludes teachers from the statutory public-sector labor act. RSMo 160.400-160.425: charter law confines charters to specified districts and defines them as independent public schools.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

NLRB R14 (St. Louis) + NLRB R17 (Kansas City) public contracts portal. Direct PDF links may require a records request for full text.

| School / Network                                         | Union                                                                                                                            | CBA Status & Term | Contract Access                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| No active certified union contracts in MO charter sector | N/A (KIPP St. Louis High AFT Local 420 unit decertified May 2024 before any CBA; Grand Center Arts 2015 attempt produced no CBA) | NONE FOUND<br>N/A | Request: <a href="mailto:Region14@nlrb.gov">Region14@nlrb.gov</a> |